



Photo for portfolio

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CHRIST UNIVERSITY

Beyond the Uniform: Life Inside the CRPF's Canine Command

On the southern outskirts of Bengaluru, beyond the expanding skyline and arterial highways, the Dog Breeding and Training School (DBTS) of the Central Reserve Police Force stands behind guarded gates and limited access. The facility is expansive — far larger than expected — stretching across training grids, kennel blocks, breeding units, a veterinary hospital and administrative offices. Movement within the campus is deliberate. Entry is controlled. The atmosphere is disciplined but not theatrical.



During a visit to the camp, a Belgian Shepherd Malinois was in the midst of an intensive drill. Lean and hyper-alert, the dog navigated ramps, tunnels and obstacle structures with explosive precision. The training layout is engineered to simulate high-risk operational scenarios. Elevated platforms test balance and nerve; narrow passages sharpen agility; scent-detection zones build focus under pressure. The Malinois displayed remarkable ferocity and courage — not uncontrolled aggression, but conditioned intensity shaped by repetition and command.

Nearly 150 K9s are trained here, each prepared for deployment in diverse and often volatile environments across the country. The campus is not merely a breeding ground; it functions as a specialised nerve centre where discipline, instinct and strategy converge.

At the helm of this institution is Deputy Inspector General Suresh S., who serves as both DIG and Principal of the DBTS camp. His role bridges operational oversight and institutional leadership, but the rhythm of life at the campus extends beyond designation. It is collective in nature — shaped by hierarchy, sustained by camaraderie.

“My day typically starts with a physical workout in the morning,” he explains. The routine begins early, followed by what he describes as a “casual inspection” of K9 facilities — including the maternity ward, veterinary hospital and ongoing training sessions. As Principal, he attends training classes at random and supervises outdoor exercises, reinforcing a culture of constant readiness.

Administrative responsibilities occupy the middle hours — crisis meetings, strategic planning and video conferences with higher offices on “budget/ works etc.” Yet the structure of his day mirrors, in many ways, the routine of the jawans under his command.

Handlers move in synchrony with their assigned dogs. Commands are brief. Responses are immediate. The bond between jawan and K9 is forged through repetition, care and mutual

dependence. While the DIG's responsibilities expand into policy and coordination, the jawans' schedules remain intensely physical — drills, endurance runs, scent tracking, feeding routines and equipment maintenance.

"In CRPF, movement is our veins," he says, referring to the transient nature of service life. Transfers and rapid deployments are embedded in the system. "Clock-work like plans" ensure operational continuity, though families often bear the emotional strain. "The families do suffer," he acknowledges, though they have "learnt to endure such hardships," with the organisation providing structured support.



By evening, the rigid tempo eases into recreation. The DIG participates in games with personnel and conducts a "random check of the Mess, where over 300 personnel dine." Inside the mess hall, steel plates line long tables and rank briefly recedes into routine. A shared meal becomes part of the leadership philosophy. A soldier, he believes, will stand alongside his commander if assured "good food and a cozy bed to sleep after the duties."

Operational stress is an undeniable component of CRPF life. Personnel "undergo a lot of stress in operational areas," he notes. Relief comes through "a professional approach, sensitive and responsive leadership," complemented by institutional stress-management programmes. Evening sports and informal interactions serve as subtle but necessary decompression.

At senior levels, decisions are "driven by public interest." Transparency and coherence guide action, even when "personal comforts are set aside." In his words, "duty comes first and foremost." That doctrine filters downward, shaping a culture where readiness outweighs convenience.

Years in uniform have reshaped his understanding of courage. The Force has faced "thousands of new challenges" across its long history, and operational commitments carry "a calculated

cost.” Such experiences cultivate sensitivity as much as resilience. The esprit-de-corps, he reflects, “teaches you a million lessons.”

He firmly corrects one persistent misconception — that the CRPF is merely a backup entity. It is not “just a ‘reserve Force’,” but a “battle-hardened, well-trained and super-disciplined Force,” often among the first responders in moments of national crisis.

Beyond insignia, he describes himself as a “nature-loving humble farmer” and a “sensitive animal lover.” The description resonates within a campus where ferocious training coexists with meticulous veterinary care and structured breeding programmes.

In a city frequently associated with corporate ambition and technological expansion, the Kaggalipura camp represents a different ecosystem — one defined by vigilance, mobility and collective endurance. The DIG’s day may include strategic meetings and administrative reviews, but it remains grounded in the same early mornings and disciplined cycles that structure the lives of the jawans.

Here, lifestyle is not spectacle. It is repetition. It is preparedness. It is learning to function within uncertainty without allowing it to fracture resolve.

Inside the gates of the CRPF’s DBTS camp in Kaggalipura, beyond ceremony and beyond stereotype, life unfolds in disciplined repetition and quiet resilience. And at its centre stands a DIG who is also a Principal — balancing command with care, authority with accessibility — embodying a way of life where service is not occasional, but continuous.



Standing by the Earth: An Interview with Environmental Activist Pallavi Gavde

In today's fast-paced world, where convenience often comes at the cost of sustainability, there are still individuals who dedicate themselves to small yet powerful acts of conservation. One such individual is Pallavi Gavde, an environmental activist whose passion for sustainability stems from her upbringing and a deeply personal connection to nature.

Pallavi's journey into environmental activism was not sparked by a sudden realization, but rather cultivated steadily from her childhood. Growing up, she was inspired by her mother, who not only enjoyed gardening but was also a conscious environmental enthusiast. Her mother's love for nurturing plants and respect for natural resources left an indelible mark on Pallavi, shaping her own values and choices. "I think it all started at home," Pallavi reflects. "Watching my mother's joy in caring for the earth made me realize that conserving nature isn't a task, it's a way of life."

What sets Pallavi apart is her strong belief in individual responsibility. While many people look to governments and institutions to take action against climate change and environmental degradation, Pallavi firmly believes that true change begins at the personal level. "The government plays no role in this," she insists. "People have to step up themselves. Each of us has the power to make a difference with the choices we make every day."

For her, conservation does not necessarily mean undertaking massive projects or campaigns. Instead, it lies in simple, everyday actions that anyone can practice. Pallavi is particularly vocal about reducing the use of disposable products, especially napkins and plastic items. She advocates for reusable alternatives, cloth bags, refillable bottles, and washable napkins that not only cut down on waste but also set an example for others to follow.

A small but symbolic habit she has practiced for years is carrying her own cloth bag whenever she goes shopping. In a world where plastic bags are often freely distributed and thoughtlessly discarded, this simple act reflects her commitment to walking the talk. She believes that such individual habits, when multiplied by millions, can dramatically reduce the burden of plastic waste on the planet.

"Carry your own water bottle, napkins, and bags," she advises passionately. "It might seem small, but these little steps add up. If every person started taking responsibility, we would see a real difference."

Pallavi does not regret the path she has chosen, even though it sometimes means extra effort or going against the norm. She proudly embraces her identity as an environmentalist, unshaken by the inconvenience or criticism it might attract. For her, standing up for the environment is not a choice but a duty, a duty owed to the Earth, which sustains all life.

Her message is simple yet urgent: think about your Mother Earth. This phrase, which she repeats often, encapsulates her philosophy. Just as one would not neglect or harm their own mother, she believes people must treat the planet with the same care and respect.

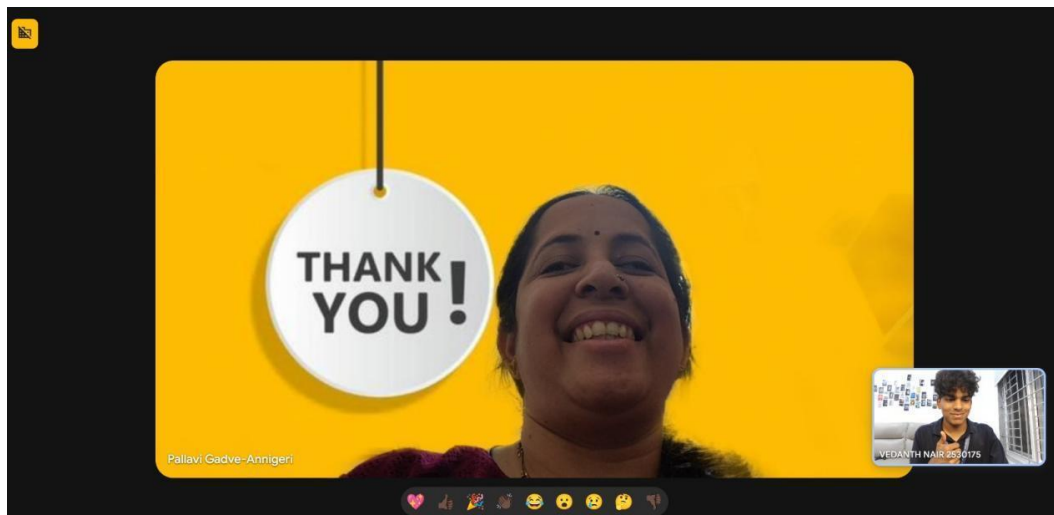
While global discussions on climate change often seem distant and technical, Pallavi's perspective brings the issue closer to home. She demonstrates that protecting the environment does not always require complex policies or large-scale protests. Instead, it begins with

conscious living questioning daily habits, resisting the culture of disposability, and making choices that align with sustainability.

Her work also challenges the narrative that only governments or corporations can bring about environmental change. In her view, true transformation comes when individuals hold themselves accountable and inspire those around them. “If you wait for the system to change,” she warns, “you might wait forever. But if you start with yourself, you create a ripple effect.”

Through her actions, Pallavi Gavde reminds us that environmental activism is not reserved for scientists, lawmakers, or international bodies. It is something anyone can practice by being mindful, responsible, and committed to conserving resources. Her story proves that every individual has a role to play in shaping a sustainable future.

As her interview comes to a close, Pallavi leaves us with a message that is both personal and universal: “Think of your planet the way you think of your family. Care for it, protect it, and never take it for granted. Because once it’s gone, there’s no replacing it.”



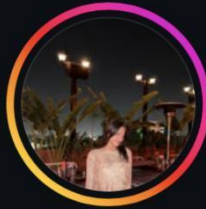




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Follow



Her mantra?

- Carry your own cloth bag
- Reuse bottles & napkins
- Say NO to disposables

Pallavi reminds us: caring for the Earth is like caring for family. Every choice counts, and together, we can build a more sustainable future



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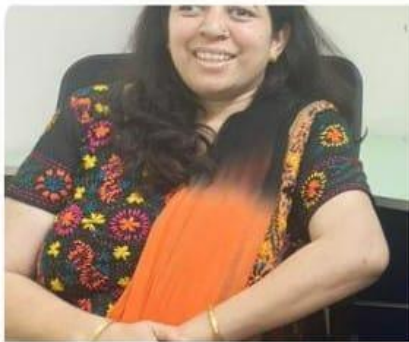
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Activist

Pallavi is a passionate advocate for sustainable living, dedicating her time and energy to building eco-conscious communities.



Meet Pallavi Gadve, an environmental activist who proves that small steps can create big change. Inspired by her mother's love for nature, she believes sustainability starts at home. Not with governments, but with us.



Her mantra?

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11:28 PM · 25/09/25



Cybercrime spike in Bangalore raises concern, Police warn young adults and women are at risk

Reporter – Vedanth Nair, 1BAJE

Bengaluru has been witnessing a surge in cases of cybercrime, police warn the public, as scammers increasingly exploit WhatsApp files and malicious APKs to target students, women, and other potentially vulnerable groups.

Cybercriminals in Bengaluru have been ramping up their operations, targeting mostly college students, women, and celebrities with deceptive tactics that exploit social trust and smartphone vulnerabilities. Officer Prashant B. Alur of Halsuru Police Station stated the scams often revolve around “college student video chats, monetary scams, stealing public information etc.” conducted predominantly through malicious Android APKs and corrupted WhatsApp files.



The primary victims, according to the police, are college students, women, and celebrities, often targeted indirectly. Alur explained that scammers frequently look for “official connections rather than the officials themselves,” suggesting that attackers exploit personal ties and weaker links in social networks rather than a direct approach.

The most common attacks include WhatsApp-based frauds, scam links, data-stealing APK downloads, and impersonation. These lead to theft of data and financial losses.

One victim, Aryan Harish, recounted his experience when questioned about how he was affected, what information the scammers had, and whether they provided any official documentation. When asked whether the scammers had any of his more personal details, Harish said they only had his name and phone number, which they used to appear more legitimate.

Responding to our question about how they first approached him, Harish explained that he had received an SMS claiming that a payment had been deposited into his account. When asked whether they provided any professional documents, he mentioned that an SMS is all he was provided.



He was also asked about how he verified the alleged payment, and Harish said he checked his SMS alerts and banking notifications. “I checked my messages and thought I had received the money,” he said. Believing the SMS to be real, he sent ₹5,000 back to the other party but later realized the supposed initial credit had never taken place.

When asked about what happened afterward, Harish said he did not face further issues after that, but the incident resulted in the teenager wanting to understand more about cybercrime and its consequences.

Situations like these reflect a wider rise in cybercrime across Karnataka. According to the NCRB Report, cybercrime cases in the state rose to over 21,000, marking it as one of the steepest increases in the country. Bengaluru remains the hub for such cases: police data appears to show the city registered over 17,000 cybercrime cases in 2024, averaging about 48 cases per day. Financial losses have climbed at an alarming rate. From approximately ₹673 crore lost in 2023, Bengaluru’s cyber-fraud losses jumped to nearly ₹2,000 crore in 2024, driven largely by digital payment fraud, and account-takeover scams. However, detection remains low: of the 17,500 cases recorded in 2024, only about 1,026 were officially “detected.”

Despite the growing number of victims, only a fraction of complaints results in actual FIRs. Karnataka received over one lakh calls to the 1930 helpline in the last year, but only around

20,000 FIRs were registered. Cyber experts say this gap between reporting and formal registration reduces the chances of timely recovery and investigation.

The Karnataka High Court had recently directed the state police to strengthen the link between the 1930 helpline and the Cyber Command Centre (CCC), calling for more stable staffing and more efficient coordination. The court also noted that frequent transfers of CCC officers were weakening investigations and delaying case follow-ups.

Experts attribute the city's vulnerability to its large and young population, heavy dependence on digital transactions, and widespread smartphone usage. With many students living away from home and managing finances independently for the first time, scammers may see them as easy targets.

Bengaluru's sharp rise in cybercrime reveals a widening gap between digital dependency and digital safety. While police recommend vigilance and public education, experts argue that long-term solutions must include better cyber-policing infrastructure, improved coordination with the Cyber Command Centre, and faster response to helpline complaints.